

THE NATION

at Rail Strike Believed Near

Justice Dept. Immigration Figures Knock Long's Story Into Cocked Hat

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WASHINGTON, Dec. 20. —During the decade 1933-42, the number of immigrants from Germany admitted to the U. S. A. was less than half the allowable quota.

This fact, gleaned from Justice Dept. records, throws new light on the claim of Assistant Secretary of State Breckinridge Long that the State Dept. had done all it could to facilitate the admission of refugees from Nazi oppression.

Under the 1924 immigration act, the German quota is 25,957 a year; the Austrian, 1413. In 1938, after the Anschluss, the Austrian quota was added to the German, making it 27,370.

For the 10 years, 1933-42, the total number of allowable immigrants from Germany and then from Austro-Germany was 266,635.

Less Than ½ of Quota

The number actually admitted in that period was 123,573.

During this period, from the moment Hitler took power in 1933, American consulates in Germany were deluged with applications for visas from "non-Aryan" Germans, Jewish and Christian, and from anti-Nazis of both faiths.

In his testimony before the House Foreign Affairs Committee Nov. 26, Long described the kind of scenes which occurred.

"One man," he told the Committee, "tried to kill himself right in front of the consul because he was ineligible to a visa to the United States under the immigration laws. Another man fell down and grasped the knees of the consul and begged, and others would fall down and kiss their feet and pray for a visa."

Judging from immigration records, consular officials were not too moved by these scenes.

In the first five years of the Hitler terror, the German quota was 25,957 per year. Here are the num-

Celler Demands That Long Quit

Rep. Emanuel Celler D., N.Y.) charged today that Breckinridge Long had outlived his usefulness as Assistant Secretary of State in charge of refugees and should resign.

"We can forgive an honest mistake," said Celler, "but the indifference and callousness of Long in his approach toward the refugee problem, coupled with a proud and haughty attitude, make him unfit to continue in the driver's seat. His usefulness has vanished; the necessary confidence in him has gone."

"He is the type that turns up his nose at the newcomer, forgetting that the pioneers who built up the land were likewise newcomers and refugees fleeing

sons actually admitted under the Polish quota was 28,579.

Here are the figures for the Polish quota, showing actual admissions per year:

1933	961
1934	1138
1935	1682
1936	1250
1937	1855
1938	4218
1939	6512
1940	4354
1941	4406
1942	2203

Although in but one of these years did admissions come anywhere near the quota, the waiting list for visas in Warsaw alone was said to have reached 50,000.

Long, testifying on the Baldwin-Rogers bill for a special agency to help rescue the Jews of occupied Europe, said the U. S. A. since Hitler's rise to power had taken in 580,000 refugees, most of them Jews.

But of this 580,000, most were ordinary immigrants, not refugees. Only 243,420 came from countries now dominated by the Axis powers. Of these, only 163,423 were Jews.

CHICAGO, Dec. 20.—The National Maritime Union, CIO, has filed a \$200,000 slander suit against the Chicago Tribune and its publisher, Robert R. McCormick. The suit is based on a story printed in the Tribune Jan. 22, 1943, reporting that sick and wounded Marines were forced to unload cargo ships at Guadalcanal because members of the Merchant Marine crews belonging to the NMU refused to work Sunday. The story was copyrighted by the Akron (O.) Beacon-Journal. Since printing the story, the Tribune has run subsequent stories representing similar incidents allegedly told it by "indignant" members of the Merchant Marine. Recently the Tribune printed a series based on the tales of a sailor who claimed that NMU members are bringing Communist literature into the U. S. A. directly from Murmansk, Russia.